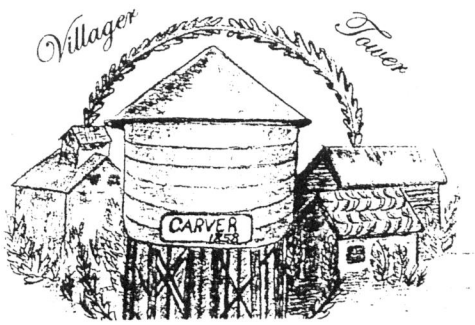
Volume XXVII
Number Two Hundred Fifty Two
November / December 2008 / January 2009



Senator Ortman

Senator Ortman attended the November council meeting inquiring if the council had any questions. The economy and recession was the topic of her conversation. Decreased Local Government Aid was brought to her attention, along with levy limits placed on cities. The senator informed the council that her vote was against the levy limits on city budgets by the governor for 2009. The council thanked the senator for her time and discussing the issues with them.

Carver County Health Partnership

Representatives from the Carver County Health Partnership Board spoke with the council regarding a partnership between Ridgeview Medical Center, Carver County and several organizations that want to make the county healthy. Cities within the county are being contacted for their support. The commission is working to make Carver County the healthiest in the United States. The city was asked for a donation.

Forner Lane Utility Improvements

The council continued the Public Hearing for Forner Lane Utility Improvements. A slide presentation was given by the city engineer. The assessment amounts process was explained. Questions were asked. Previous estimate amounts were questioned by a developer. Differences in amounts were questioned. The engineer explained that the construction costs projected for 2006 were close, indirect costs such as MnDot permits increased. Motion was made and carried with four ayes and one nay adopting the resolution adopting assessments for Forner Lane Utility Improvements.

Truth In Taxation

The council opened the Public Hearing for the Truth in Taxation. One citizen expressed concern regarding taxes increasing in Carver. The mayor explained that smaller cities have higher taxes. A graph was displayed illustrating tax rates for various Carver County cities. Larger cities have more commercial and industrial tax bases, which lower residential taxes.
Suggestion was voiced to cut some services to lower the taxes. It was pointed out that this is the first increase in a long time. Many projects and items have been cut to retain lower taxes. Departments are in need of more personnel, but it is not feasible to increase staff. Increases in house values are directed to the county Assessor's office.

City Planner

The council inquired about Tollefson's proposed development to the city planner. Inquiries were also made regarding Fleet Farm's schedule. The city planner responded that she had not heard from them.

The city planner's report also discussed attending a meeting concerning the Union Pacific Rail Line Abandonment. There was interest voiced regarding attending an upcoming meeting. This information would be forwarded to the council members.

Carver Fire and Rescue First Annual Steak Fry

The Carver Fire Department invites you to come and share in their first annual steak fry at the Village Hall on January 31st, Saturday at 4PM until 8 PM. Adults will eat for $10 a piece, Kids price is $6 or you can get a Hot Dog Meal for $3 for the those who don't really like steak. Mark your calendars, Saturday, January 31st from 4 to 8 PM.

"Wrinkles should merely indicate where smiles have been."
- Mark Twain

Miscellaneous

The council reviewed fee changes and updated land use issues adopting an ordinance to establish fees.

The council asked the city engineer if there was any updated information on the Highway # 41 issue. He did not have any new information for the council.

The other inquiry involved County Road #11 north of the city outside the proposed city limits. The last idea spoken of involved three proposed alignments. The city engineer would consult the county for any updates on this issue.

The city administrator and the mayor had attended hearings at the capital regarding state budget shortfalls. Areas where necessary cuts could be made had been discussed. The council was also in-formed that the State will cut the city's Local Government Aid and Market Value Homestead Credit. The council made a motion and carried with all ayes adopting the resolution approving the 2009 Levy and the 2009 Budget for the City of Carver.

The Home Owners Association for the LyleWood Glen development was informed that work on the development is beginning as the bank has hired a contractor.

Forner Lane Project

The city engineer reviewed the two separate contracts with the council for work on the Forner Lane project. The sanitary sewer and water main work was done under city contract in 2007. Street work was done under the Design Build Contract in 2008. An item of concern is now the center of who is responsible to correct the issue. Payment for correction would be necessary. The council was presented with a drafted change order reflecting results reached on this issue. The Change Order waives the Design Build Contractor's warranty on settlement with the issue. There could be expenses if the warranty is not adopted because MnDot cannot close out the project. The city contract work had passed inspections. Motion was made and carried with three ayes and one nay approving the design build change order.

Kerry Peterson

After the council discussion motion was made and carried with all ayes adopting the resolution for the service of Kerry Peterson. The resolution recognized Council Member Peterson's fifteen years of service as a Park and Recreation Board Member and three years of service on the city council. The mayor stated that it was a pleasure serving with Mr Peterson and he has made a large contribution to the parks for his years of service. The mayor thanked Mr Peterson. Fellow council members spoke of the guidance given, honesty, integrity and contributions to the City of Carver. Mr Peterson thought through his responses and was a good friend. Thanks Kerry Peterson for a job well done!

Stormwater

The council reviewed the MN Stormwater Utility Survey and fees charged by various cities for the service. A plan summary for stormwater was explained to the council. A cost breakdown for the projected work on the stormwater system was requested. Future maintenance work was reviewed. Suggestion was submitted to increase the stormwater fees. Council member requested an expense worksheet for more detail.

Comprehensive Plan

The city planner presented the final paperwork for the 2030 Comprehensive Plan to the city council. The Metropolitan Council had completed their formal review and changes were made to the plan per their recommendations. The Comprehensive Plan had been reviewed and recommended for approval by the Community Development Committee and the Environment Committee meetings. The full Metropolitan Council had also approved the plan. The council was provided with a copy of the Metropolitan Council's staff report inclusive of conditions attached to the approval. Clarification of some of the procedures was requested. Motion was made and carried with all ayes adoption of the resolution adopting the City of Carver's 2030 Comprehensive Plan.

2030 Carver County Comprehensive Plan

The city planner told the council that adjacent communities are required to submit their Comprehensive Plan to each other as a part of the review process. The county had provided notification that their plan was available for review in June of 2008. The staff had reviewed the plan, identified a number of items significant of con-cern and may be incompatible with the City of Carver's plan. These items have been summarized for the council's review. After this re-view, if not objectionable, these comments would be sent to the county. Motion was made and carried drafting response in letter-form to the county.

Carver Bluffs West

The city engineer informed the council that Hans Hagen Homes has requested the release of the balance on the letter of credits for Carver Bluff West. The development has had improvements installed for more than two years and has met the warranty bond period. The engineering firm reviewed the project and deemed that street and utility improvements are completed. One lot is currently unoccu-pied and yard work incomplete. The developer would provide es-crow amount to cover necessary work for completion. The engineer recommended acceptance of the improvements and to reduce the balance upon final receipt of payment on outstanding invoices/costs to the city associated with this plat. Motion was made and carried with all ayes accepting the improvements on Carver Bluffs West and reduce the Letter of Credit contingent upon receipt of final payment for all outstanding invoices, costs, and special assessment issues.

Metropolitan Council Environmental Services

The council discussed the authorization to proceed with the two stages of the Metropolitan Council Environmental Services project. Due to land acquisition issues, the Metropolitan Council requested that the project be divided into two phases. The first phase from the wastewater treatment facility to the historic water tower. This phase would contain the large lift station with the lengthiest construction time because of equipment lead time. The second phase would be from the historic water tower to the Chaska ball fields containing only piping and no street work. The construction schedule for this could be completed in one season. The reasoning for the two phases allows time to complete the project as recently discussed as December 2010. This process would also allow additional time for reviewing issues with land owner.

The Metropolitan Council Environmental Services is drafting letter regarding reimbursing the city for additional engineering services and plans. The issue was reviewed with the city attorney and recommend action contingent on receipt of the letter from the Metropolitan Council Environmental Services so that the project can continue The city engineer stated that the letter was in receipt and requesting execution between the city and the met council. Questions regarding the land acquisition was asked. Easement cost issues were of concern. Motion was made and carried with all ayes approving the engineering supplemental services agreement for the Chaska West Interceptor Phase Two contingent upon execution of an amendment to the existing construction cooperation agreement reviewed and approved by the city attorney.

Did You Know

....that in January and February 1872 seven people in Carver died of smallpox, including three children of John Blomquist.

Dahlgren Township

The Dahlgren Township Board discussed the process necessary to auction property where the former Town Hall stood. A representative from Fahey Auctions told the board that advertisement should be for approximately two months in area newspapers prior to an auction date. Fees were explained. Auction proposals would be brought up for discussion at the Annual township meeting in March. Proposal for the new Town Hall site were reviewed.

East Union Elementary Carnival

The East Union Elementary School is preparing for their carnival. Carnival Committee Chairpersons are needed to volunteer for the Food, Games, Prizes, Silent Auction and Tickets. If you are interested in helping out, contact Jackie at 448.9861 or Kjersten at 442.8808.

There will be raffle tickets sold as well. The proceeds will benefit the East Union Elementary School. The Raffle Prize is Mia, the 2008 American Girl Doll of the Year. The prize includes doll, outfit and book valued at $90. The tickets are $2.
The drawing will be held on February 6th, 2009 and you don't have to present to win. For more information, contact Jen Fox at 952.448.3811 or e-mail jennifermfox@comcast.net.

Carver Fire Department

The Carver Fire Department elected their officers for the 2009 year. They are as follows:

Chief 1 - Scott King
Chief 2 - Dan Meyer
Chief 3 - Dave Diethelm
Captain 1 - Scott Haas
Captain 2 - Randy Clay
Training Officer - Paul Young
Safety Officer - Cally Trimbo
Fire Marshall - Scott King
Secretary - Paul Young
Treasurer - Kenny Schultz
Alternate Treasurer - Mark Schmitz

Congratulations!!

Lions Lights on For Life

The Carver Lions are promoting a new project this year called *"LIONS LIGHTS ON FOR LIFE".*
This project is easy for everyone in our community to participate. We are asking everyone while driving to have their vehicle lights on 24/7. This is purely for safety, as we want to be able to see all vehicles coming, but more importantly, we want all vehicles to see us. Minnesota does have an "inclement weather law" where we should have our lights on in bad weather. Well, we all know that there is a bunch of motorists that do not do this. Let's all join in together to make this a safe holiday season and the safest winter season ever. Lights On!

Wishing All of You the Merriest Holiday Season

The Carver Lions

Chanhassen Storm

Hello Carver,

A STORM IS FORMING!

Did you know that there are just over 200 days until the new Chanhassen (Carver & Victoria) High School opens? Did you also know that our new school offers a full compliment of activities and athletic opportunities for children when school begins?

Would you like to be part of building a tradition of excellence and development of an organization with an active and involved membership that is concerned with the total activities/athletic program?

Sign up now to be a charter member of the Booster Club that supports all Chanhassen High School Activities and Athletics.
Interested? Please email Terre Kemble at: terrekemble@mchsi.com.

"Storm Chasers" Booster Club

Carver Fire Department Highlights and Community Calendar

January 2009

January 1st - New Year's Day
January 3rd - Happy Anniversary Bonnie & Stan!
January 5th - Council Meeting
Happy Anniversary Dan and Rebecca!
Happy Anniversary Marvin and Myrtle!
January 6th - Carver Business Group Meeting
Happy Anniversary Troy & Annette!
January 7th - Lions Meeting
Happy Birthday Leon!
January 12th - Park and Recreation Board Meeting
Dahlgren Township Board Meeting
January 14th - Carver Card Club
January 15th - School Board Meeting
January 17th - Happy Birthday David!
January 18th - Happy Birthday Eric!
January 19th - Martin Luther King Jr Day
Drill Night
Council Meeting
District #112 – No School
Happy Birthday Kay!
January 20th - PTO East Union Elementary
Park and Recreation Board
Heritage Preservation Commission Meeting
January 21st - Lions Meeting
January 23rd - District #112 - Workshop Day – No School
January 24th - Happy Birthday Troy!
Happy Birthday Mike!
January 26th - Happy Birthday Rich!
Happy Birthday Dan!
January 27th - Planning Commission Meeting
Happy Birthday Paul!
Happy Birthday Henry!
Happy Birthday Patty!
Happy Birthday Tiu!
January 29th - Fire Department Meeting Night
School Board Meeting
Happy Birthday Shawn!
January 30th - Happy Birthday Karen!
January 31st - Fire Department Steak Fry
Happy Birthday Trish!
Happy Anniversary Ralph and Kitty!

Park and Recreation Board

The 2009 January programs for the Parks and Recreation Department can be found on line at the city's website: www.cityofcarver.com or you can call 952.448.2290 for information.

Community Park Warming House

The Community Park Warming House hours are weekdays at 5 PM until 9 PM, Saturdays at 11 AM until 9 PM and Sundays from noon until 8 PM. Saturday and Sundays from 4 PM until 5 PM is for Leisure Skating Only, no sticks or pucks allowed.

Youth Programs

Little Learner Skating Lessons begin January 10th, Parent's Night Off Babysitting is Friday, January 23rd and the Art History Camp will be Saturdays, January 10th and 31st. For more information contact Kristy with the Park and Recreation Department.

Adult Programs

Session #1 for Hatha Yoga begins January 6th. Morning Gentle Yoga begins January 8th, Cardio-Kick #1 begins January 8th, Super-Kick Mondays begins January 5th and Cardio-Kick Saturday Sampler begins January 17th. For more information contact Kristy with the Park and Recreation Department.

Carver Card Club

The Carver Card Club get together is scheduled for Wednesday January 14th at 1 PM. Cards, games, conversation will all take place until 4 PM in the lower level of the Village Hal. Your hostess is Evelyn Grimm. Interested in bringing your favorite dessert to share and serve with coffee? Let Evelyn know at 952.448.9465. Be sure to bring a friend or family member if you want. See you then.

"Defeat is not the worst of failures. Not to have tried is the true failure!"

Tentative Agenda

City of Carver Council
Monday Evening 6:30 PM

1) Call to Order
2) Pledge of Allegiance
3) Approve Agenda
4) Petitions and Requests
5) Consent Agenda
6) Municipal Utilities Report
7) Building Inspector Report
8) City Planner Report
9) City Engineer Report
10) City Attorney Report
11) Administrator Report
12) Liaison Reports
13) Other Business
14) Adjourn

Strategic Work Session

The city council held a strategic work session where they discussed various items.

The municipal utilities rate study was discussed with a representative from Ehlers and Associates reviewing the water and sewer rate analysis of the operation and connections funds. A lengthy discussion was held regarding sewer and water fees and connection fees. Further discussions would be pursued concerning water rates, usage tier system and storm sewer rates.

Annexation issues were also discussed at the work session with the city planner and the attorney updating the council on the current developers' activities and future development predictions.

The future city hall location was briefly discussed. Suggestion was submitted to form a committee to review the item. This item will be discussed later.

The final item reviewed at the work session involved the Visioning update of tactical initiatives reviewed and progress of accomplishing tasks discussed.

Charcoal & Pencil Drawing

Learn the secrets to seeing the object, and turning it into the drawing on paper. Join Suzanne Thiesfeld in this creative drawing class, to learn the basics, brush up on skills, and sketch projects for yourself using charcoal and pencils. All materials are included. Open to all skill levels.
Adults and youth, 14 and older
Tuesdays, February 17th and 24th
Carver Village Hall
6:30 PM – 8 PM
$18.00/person

Parents Night Off Babysitting

Parents sign your kids up for a fun night at the Carver Gym and Hall Parents get an evening out, while the kids play games in the gym participate in arts and crafts, and watch a movie. Kids will be provided an evening snack. Please bring a pillow, blanket, and wear athletic shoes.
Ages 4 - 12
Friday, January 23rd
Carver Hall/Gymnasium
5:30 PM – 10 PM (Drop off and pick up anytime)
$13. / child
$6. / additional child same family

Did You Know

....that the *Carver Free Press* newspaper was established in 1875 by W. R. Colton at an unknown location. In 1878 it changed ownership and was enlarged. In 1880 it was expanded again, and in January, 1881 it was sold to Civil War veteran Herman Muehlberg, who from 1884-1897 published the newspaper on Fourth Street East at Oak Street in Carver.

Carver Lions

The Carver Lions participated in helping with the blood drive event. They greeted, helped donors sign in, served soup, chili, cookies and refreshments.

Santa's visit with the children was wonderful and so many bright eyed, curious children came to visit him. Thanks extended to everyone involved.

The senior luncheon had a great turnout. Everyone had a wonderful time, Christmas cheer was spread throughout the community. A catered lunch was served and afterwards there was visiting, cards, games and drawings, including gift certificates, poinsettias and so much fun. The seniors certainly enjoyed themselves and again thanks to all involved in making this such a successful event for our seniors.

The Lions held their annual Christmas party and one guest included the District Governor. Everyone had a superb time and a surprise visitor came to check on all the boys and girls with his reindeer. Santa was checking his 'naughty and nice' list just one more time. You will all be relieved to know that each and every Lion passed with flying colors. Santa was so proud. He stayed an extra few minutes to exchange some Christmas cheer with everyone before bidding them goodnight till next year.

In January at the Fire Department 's first steak fry, the Carver Lion's will be sponsoring and managing the bar for the event. They are all looking forward to the event. A new Lion was welcomed into the lair, Tim Carroll. Welcome aboard Tim!
The Lions donated eye exams and glasses to some Carver youths.

Another continuing event that the Lions are involved in is the presentation of dictionaries to all of the 3rd Graders at the East Union School. Again this year, the students eagerly and anxiously awaited their receipt of their own dictionary. Past stories had been told and they were all excited to see the day come in December. I bet it does not take the place of the anticipation of Santa's coming, but I bet you, it comes in as a close second. The students can hardly contain their excitement to receive the books and immediately start looking at their very own presented treasures. The Lions look forward to this event almost as much as the kids. Tales of their December com-ing precedes them. Younger students comment about how they can hardly wait until they receive theirs, having heard older students tell tales. At the end of the school year, each student signs their name in their own dictionary. All during the remainder of the school year, the teachers present different projects teaching the stu-dents how to use their new possession. The dictionary is a special presentation to the third graders. Two thirds of the book is a normal dictionary with ordinary words, but the other third of the book is filled with facts and information. There are biographies of presi-dents. There is information on states, countries, maps, planets, measurements and just all kinds of cool information seeping into their imaginations. The student's are told that there is a secret, but most of them already know that secret, so the mystery is stolen away. On the last page, the longest word in the world is written. It can take up to a whole paragraph to write it down. Certainly not a word that can be pronounced. Look what the rest of us who are not in third grade at East Union are missing! Boo hoo.
Congratulations 3rd graders! Measure your wealth well and treasure those precious memories. Again thanks to all the Lions who participate in this wonderful program.

Positive Connections

School Bus Drivers wanted. Positive Connections is accepting applications for School Bus Drivers for Chaska School District #112. Cur-rent licensed drivers welcomed. Classroom and behind the wheel training provided by experienced Driver Trainers. Offering competitive wages and a comprehensive benefit package. For more information or to schedule an appointment, please call 952.361.0899.

Disclaimer

The 'unapproved' minutes of the council and the township have been referenced for the purposes of reporting news in the "*Villager Tower*" and creating the contents of this newsletter for the purpose of informing residents in the City of Carver and the townships surrounding the city.

2008 Carver Heritage Preservation Award

Gregg and Meg Witt are recipients of the 2008 Carver Heritage Preservation Award for their restoration of the circa 1868 Henry Denny -Noah Hammerlund Hardware Store Building at 208 Broadway in downtown Carver. The award is given annually for the year's best preservation work in the Carver Historic District, which is on the National Register of Historic Places.

During October and November nominations were solicited from Carver citizens. At the November meeting of the Carver Heritage Preservation Commission the 2008 nominations were reviewed, and from them the commission selected the year's best preservation work or contribution to the Carver Historic District. The restoration took place during 2007-2008.

In 2007 the building was vacant and had suffered from years of neglect, lack of funds, and ill-advised remodeling when owner Linda Pauly of Plymouth, Minnesota began restoration of the building's exterior. A new roof was installed, missing bricks were replaced, the exterior brick was tuck-pointed and cleaned, and deteriorated limestone window lintels were replaced, with contracted work carried out by the Building Restoration Company of Minneapolis. Linda Pauly also installed new front display windows. In 2008 Gregg and Meg Witt purchased the building from Linda Pauly and restored its street-side second story veranda, added doorways, vents, furnace and air conditioning, new wiring, a rear access stair-well. They also refinished wood floors and touched virtually every surface of the building's interior. The upper portion of the building has been rented as an apartment, while the lower portion of the building is rented as commercial space. From a building long va-cant, two new income-producing units have been added to the Car-ver business district, and a building with an unsightly facade now graces Broadway in a restored condition.

The building was built about 1868 for pioneer Carver businessman, Henry Rockford Denny, who was active in Minnesota politics and the Masonic Order in Minnesota. Denny operated a hardware store out of the building for almost twenty years. It also served as Car-ver's Post Office, with Denny as postmaster. Carver City Council meetings were occasionally held in the building and Minnesota Governor Horace Austin visited Denny there in 1874.

In 1887 Denny sold the building and business to Swedish immigrant Noah Hammarlund, who was a Carver blacksmith. Hammarlund ran a hardware store out of the building for many years and it re-mained in his family for more than fifty years. Hammarlund was an avid owner of racehorses and also an active member in the Masonic Order in Carver. On June 3, 1901 Noah Hammarlund was among the first on the scene of one of Carver's most horrible crimes, which occurred across the street from the hardware store at the Basler House Hotel when hotel employee Rosa Mixa was stabbed to death by another employee, Andrew Tapper. Tapper was later hanged for the crime, the only legal hanging to occur in Carver County. In the 1950s the building served as the Carver Café.

The Witts' were presented a plaque at 6:30 p.m. January 5, 2008 at the Carver City Council meeting in Carver at the Church-by-the River on Main Street East. The Witts' will also be given a traveling recognition sign that can be placed on their restored property for one year. This will mark the second time in three years that the Witts' have received the award. They received the 2006 award for restorations of adjacent buildings at 200 and 204 Broadway.

More information about the history of Carver and the buildings in the Carver Historic District can be found by following the History of Carver links on the City of Carver website at : www.cityofcarver.com or by going to the Carver County Historical Society Website at (www.carvercountyhistoricalsociety.org) and clicking on the City of Carver Walking Tour link.

"Villager Tower"

Just wanted to extend my thanks and gratitude to everyone who has shown support through the years by their donations, contributions and kind words. We are entering into our twenty-seventh year of publication so that you all know just how supportive you all have been throughout the years. It's hard to believe that it's been that long.
If there is any announcements, updates, news, events, something you just want to share, don't forget to contact the "*Villager Tower*" at 14210 Jonathan Carver Parkway, Carver MN 55315.

RYS Creations

RYS Creations will be conducting business as an administrative assistant doing the work that managers choose not to do, nor have the expenditures to hire a full-time office person, but need the administrative paperwork completed 'Administrative Assistants replaced 'secretaries'. Along with this title change came job responsibility changes, as well. Many companies are beginning to outsource this work, saving money.

Thus is the introduction to the concept to those futuristic-minded management personnel who require to have their office work completed, but don't have enough work to justify a part or full-time individual. Or you have special needs, need the expertise of an administrative assistant? Give me a call at 952 . 448 . 5126. I have different packages, different programs, set up to coincide with your specific needs at reasonable costs. I have more than thirty seven years' experience in the office environment and am very good at what I do. Give me a call and we'll get your office work in order, save you money and time.

Trouble composing letters, memos, reports? Want someone to calculate employee timecards? Looking for an individual to straighten out your filing needs? Many of those time consuming tasks can be done cost effectively and save you time. Need a plan created, need a project researched, need a business plan or card? Give me a call and we'll talk. Incidentally, I am also a public notary. So in case on a weekend, or maybe an evening, you have a legal document you need to get notarized. The banks, businesses are all closed. Can't wait. Need it now. I can help you out with that too in the evening or on the weekend. Look forward to hearing from you. References are also available.

MUSTARD MOON

All Things Quaint & Old

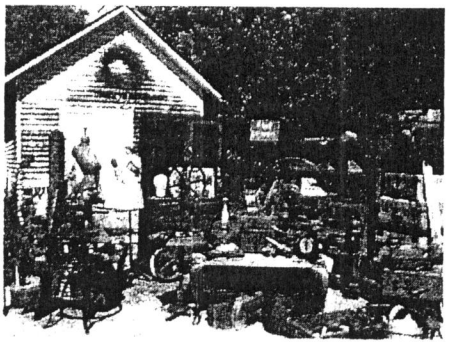
open Just 3 days
Each Month!
2009 Dates

JAN 15.16.17
FEB 19.20.21
MAR 19.20.21
APR 15.17.18
MAY 21.22.23
JUNE 18.19.20
JULY 16.17.18
AUG 20.21.22
SEPT 24.25.26
OCT 22.23.24
NOV 19.20.21
DEC 3.4.5

thur 10 - 5
fri. sat 10 - 4

300 Broadway
Carver

"Oh Mustard Moon, so old and bright,
Watch over me this starry night....
Tell me a story, quaint and old to lull
my spirit and soothe my soul."



Garlic Breath Catering

Garlic Breath Catering – Chaska/Carver - Entertaining made simple and easy by the Queen of Simplicity – Kim Rawleigh, www.garlicbreathcatering. For menu, contact: bonny@creativefibers.com.

Kim's original sauces grace most of this menu - Appetizers, entres, salads, box lunches, dessert. Available for large groups up to 250 or small intimate dinners, daily meals and catering events.

Creative Fibers Knit Shop

Creative Fibers Knit Shop in Carver...Saturday, January 17th from 10 AM to 3 PM – Open House at 101 Elm Drive. Phone: 952.200.2329. Knitting, weaving, spinning fiber books and patters – 50 % discount. Lessons by request – Bonny

It's Tax Season Again!

Is it JANUARY already? The answer is YES and that can only mean one thing, IT"S TAX SEASON AGAIN! I have never seen so much tax legislation from Congress in one year. I know money is tight, but this is the year to hire a real tax professional to make filing your taxes painless. In many cases, you'll save more tax dollars than you'll pay for the service. Helping people with their taxes is all we do and we spend an unbelievable amount of time learning all the new tax laws. Our prices are reasonable and we'll be happy to give you a free estimate. We have programs that allow your tax preparation fees to be deducted from your tax refund and also refund loan programs for those that qualify.

Some of the new laws include a credit for first time home buyers and an additional standard deduction for real estate taxes for homeowners who do not itemize their deductions. Several other tax provisions that were set to expire were also extended and some of the income limitations were changed. Did you receive your stimulus check this summer and was the amount you received correct? If not, you may be able to correct that on the 2008 tax return. Please call us at (952)240-5279 or email us at carvertax@comcast.net if we can help you with any of your tax needs. Have a fine 2009!

Cathy L. Steigerwald, E.A.
Carver Tax Service
221 Broadway, Carver, MN 55315

New Year's Resolutions

So did you make one of those dreaded resolutions again this year for 2009? Why do we do it? We know we aren't going to keep it? We know it's just 'go through the motions' and reiterate it again year after year after year, setting ourselves up for failure. So again, I ask you, why do we do it? Because everyone else does? Because that's what we are told we are supposed to do? We are masochists? We are weak? We have to be with the 'in' crowd? For whatever reasons, I am not trying to belittle anyone, judge anyone or criticize anyone. After all some of us do really carry through with those resolutions we make on that last day of the year. I just asked the question out loud not expecting any answers. Wondering if anyone else asks themselves these same questions or if by the power of suggestion one would ask themselves this after hearing someone else question it.

I say, let's try something different. Let's make a new resolution everyday. A resolution that we can actually achieve at the end of the day. Like, hug your kid today. Hug your husband or wife today? Tell someone we are sorry for some stupid thing we did? Smile today. Call a friend today. Write down a good thought today. I like this idea much better. Then we can achieve 365 daily resolutions versus one. What do you think? Rhetoric question. Unless you would really like to answer. Today, I resolve to make someone smile before the day ends.

Did You Know

.... That in February 1874 Carver druggist John Nelson was appointed an agent for the National Line (National Steam Navigation Company) and began selling ocean passage to and from many countries out of his drug store. His drug store was located on Broadway in the building currently occupied by the Carver Hair Salon.

....that in 1887 the Carver County Fair put on by the Carver County Agricultural Society was returned to Carver's Riverside Park after a hiatus of three years in Chaska.

....that in January 1874 a greater portion of Carver children were suffering from whooping cough and that even town Dr. E.H. Lewis had contracted it.

Sponsors

Carver Lions

We Serve

Carver Country Flowers & Gifts

Floral Studio inside Treasure Chest Antiques

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Carver, MN 55315

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Cell: 952-270-2717
CarverFlowers@gmail.com
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ENROLLED AGENT

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